Cabinet Dentaire du Bourg

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ADVICE SHEET 01

Healing well after an extraction

What to do in the first hours, what is normal and when to call us.

THE FIRST HOURS

- Bite on the gauze for 30 minutes without changing it.
- Do not spit or use mouthwash for 24 hours: the blood clot needs to form.
- Apply cold to your cheek (an ice pack wrapped in a cloth) for 10 minutes at a time.
- Avoid smoking and alcohol for at least 48 hours, and physical effort on the day itself.

EATING

- Choose lukewarm or cold, soft food for the first days.
- Chew on the other side and do not use a straw.

HYGIENE

- Brush your other teeth normally from the evening, gently near the treated area.
- Only use a mouthwash if it was prescribed, from the next day.

WHAT IS NORMAL

- Slight bleeding for 24 hours.
- Swelling that peaks after 2 to 3 days, then goes down.
- Moderate pain, relieved by the prescribed medication.

CALL THE PRACTICE IF

- bleeding stays heavy despite 30 minutes of pressure;
- the pain gets worse after day 3;
- you have a fever or the swelling gets worse.

Sources: UFSBD, Advice sheet: dental extractions (in French) · UFSBD, Sheet: tooth extraction (in French) · HAS (French health authority), Post-operative pain in oral surgery (2005) (in French)